Hook and Needle Sizes

Match a metric size to US letters and numbers, or to the old UK and Canadian numbers on vintage tools and patterns.

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Crochet hooks

METRIC	US	OLD UK
2.25 mm	**B-1**	13
2.75 mm	**C-2**	12[a]
3 mm	***none***	11
3.25 mm	**D-3**	10
3.5 mm	**E-4**	*none*[a]
3.75 mm	**F-5**	9
4 mm	**G-6**	8
4.5 mm	**7**	7
5 mm	**H-8**	6
5.5 mm	**I-9**	5
6 mm	**J-10**	4
6.5 mm	**K-10½**	3
7 mm	***none***[b]	2
8 mm	**L-11**	0
9 mm	**M/N-13**	00
10 mm	**N/P-15**	000
11.5 mm	**P-16**	*none*
15 mm	**P/Q**	*none*
16 mm	**Q**	*none*
19 mm	**S**	*none*
25 mm	**T/U/X**	*none*

Knitting needles

METRIC	US	OLD UK AND CANADA
2 mm	**0**	14
2.25 mm	**1**	13
2.75 mm	**2**	12
3 mm	***none***[c]	11
3.25 mm	**3**	10
3.5 mm	**4**	*none*
3.75 mm	**5**	9
4 mm	**6**	8
4.5 mm	**7**	7
5 mm	**8**	6
5.5 mm	**9**	5
6 mm	**10**	4
6.5 mm	**10½**	3
7 mm	***none***[c]	2
7.5 mm	***none***	1
8 mm	**11**	0
9 mm	**13**	00
10 mm	**15**	000
12.75 mm[d]	**17**	*none*
15 mm[d]	**19**	*none*
19 mm	**35**	*none*
25 mm	**50**	*none*

Good to know

- **Trust the mm size.** Letters and numbers can differ between brands. Some brands make a 4.25 mm G hook, for example.
- **Old UK and Canadian sizes run backwards:** the bigger the number, the thinner the needle. Old Canadian needle sizes match the old UK numbers.
- **Steel hooks for thread** are numbered the other way too: the bigger the number, the smaller the hook.

[a] A few charts put old UK 11 at 2.75 mm and old UK 9 at 3.5 mm. [b] One chart lists a US K-10¾ hook at 7 mm. [c] Some charts list US 2½ at 3 mm and US 10¾ at 7 mm. [d] Some charts list US 17 needles as 12 mm and US 19 needles as 16 mm.

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